CHALAPATHI UNIVERSITY

Guntur, Andhra Pradesh

(Established as a Brownfield University under Ordinance No. 8 of 2026, in terms of the Andhra Pradesh Private Universities (Establishment and Regulation) Act, 2016)

Ph.D. Research Regulations and Guidelines

Academic Year 2026–2027

Issued by the Dean of Research & Development

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1. Preamble

Chalapathi University, Guntur, has been established as a Brownfield University under Ordinance No. 8 of 2026, issued pursuant to the Andhra Pradesh Private Universities (Establishment and Regulation) Act, 2016 (Act No. 3 of 2016), by converting the existing constituent institution, Chalapathi Institute of Technology, Guntur, into a university. The University is sponsored by Chalapathi Educational Society, Guntur, and carries forward the Society's long-standing engagement in technical, pharmaceutical and general higher education in the region.

The University offers doctoral (Ph.D.) programmes, on a full-time and part-time basis, in keeping with the University Grants Commission (Minimum Standards and Procedure for Award of Ph.D. Degree) Regulations, 2016, and subsequent amendments, and in alignment with the National Education Policy, 2020. Each participating School maintains research infrastructure, laboratories and specialised centres to support scholars through the doctoral journey.

These Regulations govern admission, supervision, coursework, progress review, publication, thesis evaluation and the award of the Ph.D. degree at Chalapathi University for the academic year 2026–2027 and remain in force, with such amendments as the University may notify from time to time, until superseded.

2. Definitions: Unless the context otherwise requires, the following expressions carry the meanings assigned below:

i. "Act" refers to the University Grants Commission Act, 1956, the Andhra Pradesh Private Universities (Establishment and Regulation) Act, 2016, and amendments made to either from time to time.

ii. "CGPA" (Cumulative Grade Point Average) denotes a scholar's overall performance across semesters, computed as the ratio of total credit points earned to total credits undertaken, expressed to two decimal places.

iii. "Credit" denotes the quantum of weekly instruction associated with a course over a semester; a three-credit course, for instance, corresponds to three one-hour sessions each week.

iv. "Commission" refers to the University Grants Commission constituted under Section 4 of the UGC Act, 1956.

v. "Course" means a defined unit of study forming part of a programme.

vi. "Coursework" refers to the set of courses that the School/Department prescribes for scholars registered for the Ph.D. degree.

vii. "Degree" means a degree conferred by a Higher Educational Institution under Section 22(3) of the UGC Act.

viii. "External Examiner" means a published academician or researcher who is not affiliated with the institution where the scholar is registered.

ix. "Foreign Educational Institution" means an institution duly incorporated in its home country that offers face-to-face programmes leading to a degree, excluding distance, online or ODL provision.

x. "Grade Point" denotes the numerical weight assigned to a letter grade on a 10-point scale.
xi. "Research Supervisor" means an academician or researcher recognised by the University to guide a scholar's doctoral research.
xii. "Interdisciplinary Research" means research undertaken by a scholar spanning two or more academic disciplines.
xiii. "Open and Distance Learning Mode" and "Online Mode" carry the meanings assigned under the UGC (Open and Distance Learning Programmes and Online Programmes) Regulations, 2020, as amended.
xiv. "Plagiarism" means presenting another person's work or ideas as one's own.
xv. "Programme" means a higher education programme leading to a degree specified under Section 22(3) of the UGC Act.
xvi. "Research Proposal" means the outline of proposed research submitted along with the application for Ph.D. registration.
xvii. "University" means Chalapathi University, Guntur, and includes any institution deemed a university under Section 3 of the Act.

Terms used but not defined in these Regulations shall carry the meaning assigned to them in the Act, to the extent consistent with these Regulations.

3. Schools, Departments and Areas of Research

Chalapathi University currently offers doctoral research in eight departments across the following broad areas:

- Ph.D. in Engineering — Civil Engineering, Electronics & Communication Engineering, Electrical and Electronics Engineering, Mechanical Engineering, and Computer Science Engineering and allied branches.
- Ph.D. in Sciences, Business and Management and Humanities

3.1 Minimum Educational Qualifications

- Ph.D. in Engineering: a master's degree in Engineering/Technology or an equivalent qualification with a minimum of 55% marks from a UGC-recognised university.
- Ph.D. in Sciences, Management, and Humanities: a master's degree or equivalent in the relevant area with a minimum of 55% marks from a UGC-recognised university.

3.2 Eligibility at a Glance

School	Department	Ph.D. Programme Offered	Minimum Eligibility
School of Engineering	Civil Engineering	Ph.D. in Civil Engineering	PG degree in the relevant discipline (or equivalent)

School	Department	Ph.D. Programme Offered	Minimum Eligibility
			with a minimum of 55% marks
	Electronics & Communication Engineering	Ph.D. in Electronics & Communication Engineering	PG degree in the relevant discipline (or equivalent) with a minimum of 55% marks
	Electrical and Electronics Engineering	Ph.D. in Electrical and Electronics Engineering	PG degree in the relevant discipline (or equivalent) with a minimum of 55% marks
	Mechanical Engineering	Ph.D. in Mechanical Engineering	PG degree in the relevant discipline (or equivalent) with a minimum of 55% marks
School of Computing Sciences	Computer Science & Engineering and Allied Branches	Ph.D. in Computer Science & Engineering	PG degree in Computer Science & Engineering or an allied branch (or equivalent) with a minimum of 55% marks
School of Sciences and Humanities	Mathematics / Physics / Chemistry/English	Ph.D. in the respective subject	PG degree in the relevant discipline (or equivalent) with a minimum of 55% marks
School of Business and Management	Management	Ph.D. in Management	PG degree in Management (or equivalent) with a minimum of 55% marks

3.3 Additional Eligibility Notes

i. Candidates who have completed an M.Phil. programme with at least 55% aggregate marks (or an equivalent grade, or an equivalent foreign qualification duly accredited) are eligible for Ph.D. admission.

ii. A relaxation of 5% marks, or the equivalent grade, is available to candidates from SC/ST/OBC (non-creamy layer), Differently Abled, Economically Weaker Section (EWS) and other categories recognised by the UGC from time to time.

4. Duration of the Programme

i. Full-time: minimum three years, maximum six years, from the date of admission.
ii. Part-time: minimum four years, maximum eight years, from the date of admission; the thesis may not be submitted before the completion of four years.
iii. A grace period of 30 days beyond the maximum permissible duration is allowed for thesis submission.
iv. Women scholars and Persons with Disabilities (40% or greater disability) may be granted a further relaxation of up to two years, provided the total duration does not exceed ten years from the date of admission.
v. Full-time women scholars are entitled to Maternity Leave/Child Care Leave of up to 240 days, availed once during the programme.

5. Admission Procedure

i. Admissions are conducted through a transparent, merit-based process. The Vice-Chancellor determines the intake for each programme, subject to ratification by the Board of Management and the Academic Council.
ii. Admission begins with the Chalapathi University Research Aptitude Test (CU-RAT), conducted online or offline, publicised through an open and inclusive notification.
iii. A departmental selection committee, constituted by the Vice-Chancellor, evaluates each candidate's performance in CU-RAT and in a subsequent interview, and recommends suitable candidates to the Dean-R&D.
iv. Candidates who hold a valid UGC-NET/CSIR-JRF/SLET/GATE qualification, a teacher fellowship, an M.Phil. Degree, or a qualifying score in the Andhra Pradesh Research Common Entrance Test (APRCET) may be exempted from CU-RAT, but must still clear the University interview.
v. The Dean of Research and Development confirms admissions on the recommendation of the departmental selection committees, subject to ratification by the Board of Management and the Academic Council.
vi. Foreign Nationals, Persons of Indian Origin and NRIs sponsored under a government exchange arrangement, or applying on their own initiative, may be admitted directly on meeting the eligibility norms, subject to clearing the University interview.

6. Allocation of Research Supervisor

i. A selected scholar must obtain the written consent of a supervisor from the University's approved panel before registration is finalised.
ii. Where a research topic is interdisciplinary and requires complementary expertise, the University may appoint a co-supervisor, drawn either from

Chalapathi University or from a recognised research organisation approved by the University.

iii. The list of approved supervisors and their areas of research is published and maintained on the University website.

7. Doctoral Coursework

i. A minimum of 12 credits is required, comprising one course in Research Methodology and one course in Research & Publication Ethics, in addition to two discipline-specific courses.

ii. Course 1 — Research Methodology (2 credits) and Course 2 — Research & Publication Ethics (2 credits) may be completed through the University or through an equivalent NPTEL/SWAYAM certification of at least 8 weeks.

iii. Courses 3 and 4 — two discipline-relevant courses of 4 credits each, offered by the concerned School/Department, through an allied PG programme, or via an NPTEL/SWAYAM PG-level certification, subject to the supervisor's approval.

iv. Coursework must be completed within two years of admission for both full-time and part-time scholars, with a minimum of 75% attendance in each taught course (online certifications are exempt from this requirement); scholars failing to meet the attendance norm must repeat the course.

v. Scholars must communicate their chosen courses to the Dean, Research & Development, with the endorsement of the supervisor and co-supervisor (where applicable), along with the syllabus of each selected course.

vi. Scholars completing courses via NPTEL/SWAYAM must submit the completion certificate, along with grades endorsed by the Research Supervisor, to the Dean, R&D, through the proper channel.

vii. A minimum of 55% marks in each course is required to pass.

viii. Scholars unable to clear an NPTEL/SWAYAM course may opt for the corresponding offline course offered by the University, when available.

ix. Scholars who do not clear a course on the first attempt are permitted up to four further attempts. Registering for an examination without appearing does not count as an attempt. A scholar who fails to clear all prescribed courses within a maximum of five attempts is liable to have the admission cancelled.

8. Research Review Meetings (RRM)

i. Research Review Meetings (RRMs) are conducted by the Research Review Committee (RRC) once every six months to assess the quality and pace of each scholar's research and to provide direction for its improvement.

ii. A scholar registers for an RRM on the recommendation of the Research Supervisor, based on the progress demonstrated.

iii. At each scheduled RRM, the scholar presents the current status of the research before the Research Review Committee.

iv. **Minimum Attendance at RRMs:** Every scholar must satisfy the following attendance requirements:
   a) **Full-time scholars:** must attend at least one RRM per year, with a minimum of four (04) RRMs over the programme.
   b) **Part-time scholars:** must attend at least one RRM per year, with a minimum of four (04) RRMs over the programme.

v. The Research Review Committee submits a six-monthly progress report on each scholar to the University, with a copy furnished to the scholar.

9. Publication Requirements

i. A scholar must have at least three (03) published papers prior to submitting the thesis for adjudication.
ii. Of these, at least two (02) papers must appear in Scopus/Web of Science indexed journals; the remaining publication may be a conference paper.
iii. Papers published prior to admission are not counted towards this requirement.
iv. Every qualifying publication must carry Chalapathi University as the scholar's affiliation.
v. Only publications listing both the scholar and the supervisor(s) as authors are considered.

10. Submission of Synopsis

Before submitting the dissertation/thesis, a scholar must submit a hard copy and a soft copy of the synopsis, together with a supervisor/co-supervisor-approved draft thesis, to the Dean, Research & Development through the HOD of concerned Department. On the R&D Cell's direction, the scholar presents the work before the Doctoral Research Committee (DRC) in a session open to all faculty and research scholars. The R&D Cell informs the concerned Board of Studies Chairman and the supervisor(s) in advance, and feedback received is incorporated into the draft thesis in consultation with the Research Supervisor. The Doctoral Research Committee must certify the scholar's eligibility, including completion of the minimum number of RRMs prescribed under Section 8, before the thesis is submitted.

11. Anti-Plagiarism Requirements

i. Before submission, the scholar must submit the thesis for a plagiarism check using the University's approved software. Submission of the thesis shall be permitted only if the similarity index is 20 percent or lower. In addition, content generated using Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools shall not exceed 15 percent of the work.
ii. The thesis must be accompanied by an originality report generated by the anti-plagiarism tool (including AI generated). The supervisor (and co-supervisor,

where applicable) receives this report and takes it into account when certifying the thesis for submission.

12. Thesis Submission

i. Part-time scholars submit the thesis to the Dean, Research & Development through the HOD of concern Department; full-time scholars route the submission through the Department to the Dean, R&D.

ii. On completion of all requirements, the scholar submits six (6) soft-bound hard copies of the thesis, incorporating all changes recommended by the Doctoral Research Committee during the pre-submission seminar.

iii. A scholar may not submit the whole or a substantial part of the thesis toward a degree or diploma of another university.

13. Thesis Evaluation

i. The Vice-Chancellor appoints three examiners for each thesis, drawn from a panel of nine recommended by the supervisor, ensuring geographic and institutional diversity: three from IITs/NITs/IIITs/Central Universities, three from State Government universities, and three from private universities or autonomous Institutions.

ii. Each examiner reviews the thesis independently and submits a report with a clear recommendation on its quality and acceptability.

iii. Examination Outcomes: The examination of the Ph.D. thesis shall result in one of the following four outcomes:

a) **Acceptance:** The thesis is accepted without further substantive revision, and the candidate shall be permitted to proceed to the **viva-voce examination**.

b) **Minor Revision and Resubmission:** The thesis requires minor corrections or revisions. The candidate shall revise and resubmit the thesis for consideration, following which the candidate shall be permitted to proceed to the **viva-voce examination**, subject to satisfactory compliance with the examiners' recommendations.

c) **Major Revision and Re-evaluation:** The thesis requires substantial revision. The candidate shall revise and resubmit the thesis, which shall subsequently be **re-evaluated** in accordance with the University's prescribed procedure.

d) **Rejection:** The thesis does not satisfy the prescribed academic and research standards and shall therefore be **rejected**.

e) Decision in Cases of Divergent Examiner Recommendations: Where the recommendations of the three examiners differ, the final decision shall be determined in accordance with the Thesis Examination Decision Matrix given below.

Thesis Examination Decision Matrix:

Examiner 1	Examiner 2	Examiner 3	Resulting Decision
Accept	Accept	Accept	Degree Recommended (Accept)
Revise	Revise	Revise	Revise and Resubmit
Reject	Reject	Reject	Reject
Accept	Accept	Revise	Accept
Accept	Revise	Revise	Revise and Resubmit
Accept	Accept	Reject	Accept
Accept	Reject	Reject	Revise; Refer to a Fourth Examiner
Accept	Revise	Reject	Revise; Refer to a Fourth Examiner
Revise	Revise	Reject	Revise; Refer to a Fourth Examiner
Revise	Reject	Reject	Reject

f) In cases where the decision matrix requires referral to a fourth examiner, the revised thesis and/or the relevant examination reports shall be referred to the fourth examiner in accordance with the University's prescribed procedure. The final decision shall be taken after consideration of the fourth examiner's report and other applicable examination requirements.

g) All revisions and resubmissions shall be completed within the period prescribed by the University. The candidate shall be required to satisfactorily address the substantive observations and recommendations of the examiners before being permitted to proceed to the viva-voce examination or before the degree is recommended, as applicable.

iv. Final Decision: The final examination outcome shall be formally approved and communicated by the University in accordance with the applicable Ph.D. Regulations and the decision matrix prescribed herein. Where a thesis is referred to a fourth examiner, that examiner's recommendation is final. A scholar granted revision has up to one year from the date of communication to resubmit; the revised thesis is referred

back to the examiner who originally recommended revision. Where an examiner's report is unduly delayed, the Vice-Chancellor may appoint a replacement examiner.

14. Viva-Voce Examination

i. The open viva-voce is scheduled only once the external examiner reports are satisfactory and recommend the award of the degree.
ii. A committee appointed by the Vice-Chancellor conducts the viva-voce in the presence of the Board of Studies Chairman of the Department; the committee comprises the Research Supervisor and Co-Supervisor (where applicable) and one of the thesis examiners nominated by the Vice-Chancellor.
iii. The joint decision of the internal (supervisor) and external examiner on the committee is final for conferring the degree.
iv. The viva-voce is open to members of the Department and allied departments, and the scholar must successfully defend the thesis.
v. A scholar who does not clear the viva-voce may reattempt it within three months, subject to a maximum of two attempts; an unsuccessful second attempt is referred to the Vice-Chancellor for review.
vi. Following the viva-voce, the committee forwards its recommendation, along with a soft copy of the thesis submitted by the scholar, to the Dean of R&D for uploading to INFLIBNET (Shodhganga) through the UGC.
vii. The Ph.D. degree is conferred only after the thesis has been uploaded to Shodhganga/INFLIBNET.
viii. The University issues a provisional certificate confirming the award of the degree, in accordance with the applicable UGC Regulations, pending issue of the formal degree certificate.

15. Change of Research Topic

A scholar seeking to change the research topic must submit an application in the prescribed format, together with a fee of ₹5,000/-; the change is permitted on the recommendation of the Chairman, Board of Studies, and with the approval of the Vice-Chancellor. Thesis submission is permitted only after one year from the date of the change, and the exact thesis title is finalised at the pre-submission seminar.

16. Change of Supervisor(s)

A request to change a supervisor or co-supervisor, made for valid reasons, is considered by the University on its merits. Where the change is approved, the scholar may submit the thesis only after one year from the date of the change or the inclusion of an additional supervisor. Publications made with the earlier supervisor/co-supervisor that meet the publication norms continue to be counted.

17. Conversion between Full-Time and Part-Time Registration

Conversion from full-time to part-time status, or vice-versa, requires the Vice-Chancellor's approval and may be granted only once during the scholar's tenure. The request must be supported by the supervisor's recommendation, submitted after completion of one year from the date of registration, and accompanied by a conversion fee of ₹5,000/-.

18. Fees

- Full-Time Tuition Fee: ₹20,000/- per semester.
- Part-Time Tuition Fee: ₹30,000/- per semester.

The fee is payable on or before the commencement of each academic year, until successful completion of the programme and thesis submission, or cancellation of admission. A late fee of ₹2,000/- applies where payment is delayed beyond the due date, provided it is made within six months of that date. Scholars must retain all fee receipts and produce them when required. Where registration is cancelled — whether at the scholar's request or by the University — the full fee due up to the date of cancellation remains payable. Full-time scholars whose services are engaged by the Department are paid a stipend of ₹25,000/- per month for a period of three (03) years.

19. Research Review Committee (RRC)

19.1 Composition

i. Chairperson: the Chairman, Board of Studies (where the Chairman is the scholar's supervisor, or does not hold a doctorate, the Vice-Chancellor appoints a suitably qualified doctoral faculty member from the Department instead).
ii. Convener: the Research Supervisor or Co-Supervisor.
iii. Expert Members: at least one senior external faculty member from outside the University, and one competent doctoral faculty member from the Department, both nominated by the Vice-Chancellor from a suggested panel.
iv. Where a member is on leave exceeding one year, resigns, or retires, the Vice-Chancellor nominates a replacement on the recommendation of the Chairperson, Doctoral Committee.

19.2 Functions of Research Review Committee (RRC)

i. Conducting Research Review Meetings.
ii. Assessing research progress and offering improvement suggestions.
iii. Reviewing compliance with suggestions made at earlier RRMs.
iv. Recording reasons for unsatisfactory progress and recommending corrective measures where necessary.
v. Confirming, at the final RRM before the pre-submission seminar, that earlier recommendations have been addressed.

20. Doctoral Research Committee (DRC)

20.1 Constitution

Every Department offering the Ph.D. programme shall have a Doctoral Research Committee, constituted by the Vice-Chancellor. Where a Department has fewer than three recognised Research Supervisors, the DRC shall be constituted at the School/Faculty level for all Departments in that School. Supervisors from allied disciplines may be co-opted to make up the number.

Composition

S. No.	Member	Role
1	Head of the Department. If the HoD is not a recognised Research Supervisor, the Dean of the School or a senior Professor nominated by the Vice-Chancellor	Chairperson
2	Dean, Research & Development	Ex-officio Member
3	All recognized Research Supervisors of the Department who are regular full-time faculty	Members
4	One subject expert from outside the University, of Professor rank, from a UGC-recognised University or Institution of National Importance, nominated by the Vice-Chancellor from a panel submitted by the Chairperson	External Member
5	Ph.D. Coordinator of the Department	Member-Secretary

20.2 Functions of the Doctoral Research Committee (DRC)

i. Conducting the pre-submission seminar.
ii. Recommending changes to the draft thesis presented at the seminar.
iii. Certifying the thesis for final submission.
iv. Finalising the title of the thesis.

21. General Provisions

i. These Regulations are to be read as a whole for purposes of interpretation.
ii. If a Ph.D. scholar commits malpractice in an examination, in course work or in any other academic activity, action shall be taken as per the Regulations of the University, adapted as required for doctoral scholars.
iii. Every Ph.D. thesis shall be checked using the plagiarism detection software prescribed by the University. A similarity index of more than 20 percent, or AI-generated content of more than 15 percent, shall not be accepted. Any work exceeding either limit shall be returned to the scholar for revision. Cases of plagiarism shall be dealt with as per the UGC (Promotion of Academic Integrity and Prevention of Plagiarism in Higher Educational Institutions) Regulations, 2018.

iv. Masculine pronouns used in these Regulations include the feminine, and vice-versa.

v. In case of doubt or ambiguity in interpreting these Regulations, the decision of the Vice-Chancellor is final.

vi. The University may amend these Regulations or the associated syllabi at any time; such amendments apply to all scholars on rolls from the date notified by the University.

vii. The University may cancel a scholar's registration, after due notice, where the scholar fails to satisfy the conditions of the admission order or violates these Regulations.

viii. Admitted scholars are advised to periodically consult the University website, https://www.chalapathiuniversity.edu.in, for updates and instructions.

ix. For any clarification, scholars may contact the Dean of Research & Development, Chalapathi University, Guntur.